

The Current Affairs System

Chapter F10.1 — A Method and a Watchlist, Because a Printed List of Facts Decays

Module	Foundation Layer — Module 10 — Integrated Current Affairs
Chapter	Chapter F10.1
Topic	Official syllabus head — Current Events and Developmental Issues
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Exam stage	Recruitment Test (RT)

IMPORTANT · THE HONEST POSITION ON THIS MODULE, STATED FIRST

Module 10 is **20.0 planning marks over 12 hours** — eight questions — and it is the only module in this manual that **cannot be finished**. Every other module is a closed body of material. This one acquires new content every week until the day of the paper.

So a chapter that is merely a list of facts is the wrong deliverable. A list compiled in August 2026 for a paper written in November or December 2026 is wrong about everything that happens in between, and worse, it is **confidently** wrong — the failure mode F4.1 §0 introduced the dated-figure convention to prevent.

What this chapter is instead: a **collection system** (§3), a **verification protocol** (§4), and a **watchlist of the specific things this examination asks about** (§5). It also contains the part of current affairs that does **not** decay — §2's institutional attributions, which are what "current affairs" questions in this examination overwhelmingly test.

F10.2 is the dossier: the facts as they stood on 16 August 2026, dated and sourced, to be re-verified against §4's checklist before the paper.

That division — the method here, the perishable content there, clearly separated — is the only honest way to put current affairs in a printed manual. It is the same principle as F8.0's calendar declaring that it schedules existing questions rather than pretending to contain new ones.

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0. How This Chapter Works

STUDY SESSION · CHAPTER F10.1

1. **Session 1** — What a printed chapter can and cannot do (§1) ★★☆☆
2. **Session 2** — What "integrated" means, and the attributions that do not decay (§2) ★★★★★
3. **Session 3** — The collection system (§3) ★★★★★
4. **Session 4** — The verification protocol (§4) ★★★★★
5. **Session 5** — The EPFO-specific watchlist (§5) ★★★★★

Then 20 graded questions in §6 — deliberately built on the **non-decaying** part of the syllabus, so that this bank is still valid whenever you drill it.

Do not read this chapter once and file it. §3 is a daily habit and §4 is a task for the fortnight before the paper.

1. Session 1 — What Is Actually Being Tested ★★☆☆

1.1 The three kinds of "current affairs" question

Kind	Example	Decays?
1 Institutional attribution	Which body publishes the Human Development Report?	No — permanent
2 A recent, definite change	GST now has how many main slabs? What replaced EPS-95?	Slowly — stays askable for years
3 A current reading	What is the repo rate? The unemployment rate?	Fast — months

MUST MASTER · MOST OF THIS MODULE'S MARKS ARE IN KINDS 1 AND 2, NOT KIND 3

This is the judgement that decides how to spend the twelve hours.

Kind 3 — the current reading — is what candidates fear and what they spend their time on. It is also the **least** of the three in yield, because a paper set months before it is sat cannot safely ask for a number that moves weekly, and because the setter knows it.

Kind 1 is permanently askable and permanently learnable. Who publishes the World Development Report has been the same answer for forty years and will be the same answer in November. §2.2's table is therefore the highest-value page in this module, and it can be finished in an evening.

Kind 2 is the sweet spot — a definite change, recent enough that older material is wrong, stable enough to be a fair question. **The four labour codes coming into force, GST's two slabs, the Income-tax Act 2025, the Employees' Pension Scheme 2026.** These are what F10.2 is built around, and F4.3's opening callout shows the pattern.

So spend the twelve hours roughly: four on §2's attributions, six on F10.2's kind-2 changes, and two on the §4 sweep in the fortnight before the paper. Not twelve on chasing the news.

1.2 Where the marks actually sit for this examination

Blueprint §4.4's record of the 2023 paper shows current affairs appearing **inside other modules** rather than as a labelled block — a question on a labour statute's amendment reads as labour law; a question on the Budget reads as economy.

That is what "integrated" in the module's name means, and it has a practical consequence: **a current affairs item is only worth learning if it attaches to something in the static syllabus.** The attachment

points, in order of yield for this post, are:

1. **Labour law and social security** — Modules 2 and 3
2. **The economy** — Module 4
3. Polity and governance — Module 1
4. Science and technology — Module 9

Sport, entertainment, obituaries and general trivia are **not** on that list. They are the bulk of a commercial current affairs magazine and close to zero of this paper.

CHECK YOURSELF · SESSION 1

1. Name the three kinds of current affairs question and say which decays fastest
2. Which kind carries the most marks, and why is it not the kind candidates fear?
3. How should the twelve hours be divided?
4. What does "integrated" mean, and which four attachment points matter?

2. Session 2 — The Attributions That Do Not Decay ★★★★★

2.1 Why this is the best-value section in the module

A question asking **who publishes what** has a permanent answer, is easy to set, is unambiguous, and separates prepared candidates from unprepared ones. Every examiner likes all four properties. Learn the table and a predictable share of the eight marks becomes safe.

2.2 Reports and their publishers

MUST MASTER · THE REPORT-TO-PUBLISHER TABLE

Report / Index	Published by
Human Development Report , HDI, IHDI, GII	UNDP
Global Multidimensional Poverty Index	UNDP with OPHI (Oxford)
National Multidimensional Poverty Index , SDG India Index	NITI Aayog
World Development Report , Human Capital Index	World Bank
World Economic Outlook , Fiscal Monitor	IMF
Global Competitiveness Report , Global Gender Gap Report	World Economic Forum
Global Innovation Index	WIPO — the World Intellectual Property Organization
Corruption Perceptions Index	Transparency International
Global Hunger Index	Concern Worldwide and Welthungerhilfe
World Happiness Report	UN Sustainable Development Solutions Network
Press Freedom Index	Reporters Without Borders (RSF)
State of World Population	UNFPA
State of Food Security and Nutrition in the World	FAO (with WFP, WHO, UNICEF, IFAD)
World Employment and Social Outlook , Global Wage Report	ILO
Economic Survey	Department of Economic Affairs , under the Chief Economic Adviser
GDP, CPI, IIP, PLFS	NSO , under MoSPI
Wholesale Price Index	Office of the Economic Adviser , Ministry of Commerce and Industry
CPI-IW	Labour Bureau

Report / Index	Published by
Annual Status of Education Report (ASER)	Pratham Education Foundation — a private body, not government
National Family Health Survey (NFHS)	Ministry of Health and Family Welfare, through IIPS
Sample Registration System (SRS)	Registrar General of India

The three traps in that table:

1. **World Bank against IMF.** *Development and Human Capital* are World Bank; *Outlook and Fiscal Monitor* are IMF. The two are both Bretton Woods institutions in Washington, which is why they are offered for each other — F4.5 §4.3
2. **WEF against UNDP.** The **Gender Gap** report is the **World Economic Forum**; the **Gender Inequality Index** is **UNDP**. Two gender indices, two different bodies, and the names are close enough to swap
3. **The private publishers.** **ASER is Pratham**, not the government. The **Global Hunger Index** is two European NGOs, not the FAO. Candidates assume an official-sounding index must be official

And one discontinued report worth knowing: the World Bank **stopped publishing the Ease of Doing Business rankings** in 2021. A question asserting that it still does is wrong, and it is the sort of stale fact that survives in coaching material for years.

2.3 The bodies most relevant to this post

Body	Facts worth holding
ILO	Founded 1919 , under the Treaty of Versailles; the oldest UN specialised agency; became a UN agency in 1946; headquarters Geneva ; tripartite — governments, employers and workers; India a founder member
EPFO	Administers the 1952 Act's schemes; apex body the Central Board of Trustees (CBT) , chaired by the Union Minister for Labour and Employment ; also tripartite
ESIC	Employees' State Insurance Corporation — medical and cash benefits
e-Shram	The national database of unorganised workers
NPCI	Operates UPI — relevant because EPFO 3.0 settlement runs on it

KNOW · THE ILO'S TRIPARTISM IS THE MOST EXAMINABLE THING ABOUT IT

The ILO is **unique among UN specialised agencies in its tripartite structure**: each member State's delegation comprises **two government delegates, one employers' delegate and one workers' delegate**, and the employer and worker delegates vote **independently of their government**.

That structure is mirrored in India's own **Central Board of Trustees**, which likewise seats government, employer and employee representatives — and it is the institutional expression of the idea that labour standards are negotiated rather than imposed.

For the interview: tripartism explains why labour law reform in India moves slowly and why the four labour codes took from 2019 to 2025 to come into force. It is a better answer than "bureaucratic delay".

CHECK YOURSELF · SESSION 2

1. Name the publisher of each: HDR, World Development Report, World Economic Outlook, Global Innovation Index, Global Hunger Index, Gender Gap Report
2. Which two gender indices come from which two bodies?
3. Which well-known report did the World Bank discontinue?
4. Give the ILO's founding year, headquarters, and the feature that makes it unique
5. Who chairs the Central Board of Trustees?

3. Session 3 — The Collection System ★★★★★

3.1 The sources, in priority order

Priority	Source	Why
1	PIB (pib.gov.in) press releases	The primary source. Every scheme, appointment and Cabinet decision appears here first and in official wording
2	One national newspaper , read for editorials and the economy pages	<i>The Hindu</i> or <i>Indian Express</i> . One , daily — not three, weekly
3	Ministry of Labour and EPFO circulars	Directly on this examination's subject. Circulars on the EPFO site are the single most targeted source available
4	PRS Legislative Research (prsindia.org)	Bill and Act summaries, Budget analysis, committee reports — the fastest way to get a statute's substance
5	RBI and MoSPI press releases	For the policy rates and the statistics
6	Economic Survey and Budget documents	Once a year, read the highlights

Not on the list, deliberately: current affairs YouTube channels, daily quiz apps, and monthly compilation magazines. Blueprint §22 permits coaching material as *supplementary*; it should not be the primary channel, because it optimises for volume of items rather than for the attachment points §1.2 identifies.

3.2 The daily habit — fifteen minutes

MUST MASTER · ONE PAGE A MONTH, IN FOUR COLUMNS

The failure mode in current affairs is not insufficient reading. It is **reading without recording**, which produces a sense of familiarity and no retrievable knowledge.

The format — one sheet per month, four columns:

Date	Item	Which module it attaches to	Why it might be asked
21 Nov 2025	Four labour codes brought into force	M2, M3	Replaces 29 Acts; makes older answers wrong
22 Sep 2025	GST to two slabs, 5% and 18%	M4	Definite, recent, contradicts every textbook
29 Jun 2026	EPS 2026 replaces EPS-95	M3	Directly on this post's subject matter

The third column is the one that does the work. An item that cannot be attached to a module is an item to **discard** — that is the operational meaning of "integrated", and it is what keeps the register to one page a month instead of ten.

Fifteen minutes a day: ten reading PIB and the paper, five recording. Any item you cannot summarise in one line does not go in.

3.3 The monthly consolidation — thirty minutes

At the end of each month:

1. **Re-read the month's sheet** and strike out anything that has not turned into a durable fact
2. **Move surviving items** into the relevant module's revision notes — a labour item goes to Module 2's notes, not into a separate current affairs pile
3. **Write five questions** on the month's items, in the paper's four-option format, and add them to your error log's drill

Step 2 is what makes the module *integrated* rather than parallel. **By the end you should not have a current affairs file at all** — you should have Modules 1 to 9, updated.

CHECK YOURSELF · SESSION 3

1. List the top four sources in priority order
2. What are the four columns of the monthly sheet, and which one decides whether an item is kept?
3. How long is the daily habit, and how is it split?
4. What happens to items at the monthly consolidation, and why?

4. Session 4 — The Verification Protocol ★★★★★

MUST MASTER · THE FORTNIGHT-BEFORE SWEEP, ITEM BY ITEM

Every figure in this manual marked **[AS AT 16 AUG 2026]** must be re-checked before you sit the paper. This is the checklist. It takes about **two hours** and it is the highest-return two hours in the module, because it converts a set of possibly-stale facts into a set of certainly-current ones.

#	Check	Where	Chapter to update
1	Repo rate , SDF, MSF, stance	RBI latest MPC statement	F4.2 §2.3
2	CPI inflation , latest and projected	RBI policy statement, MoSPI	F4.2 §3.3
3	GDP growth , latest estimate and which estimate it is	MoSPI press release	F4.1 §3.1
4	Fiscal deficit target, current year	Budget at a Glance	F4.3 §2.2
5	EPF interest rate for the current year, and whether ratified	EPFO / PIB	F10.2 §2
6	EPF wage ceiling — still ₹15,000, or revised?	EPFO / PIB	F10.2 §2
7	Any new EPFO scheme or circular	EPFO website	F10.2 §2
8	Labour code rules — further notifications	Ministry of Labour	F10.2 §1
9	Unemployment rate , LFPR	MoSPI monthly PLFS	F4.4 §2.2
10	Census 2027 progress and any date change	censusindia.gov.in	F4.5 §2.3
11	GST — any further rate change	GST Council press release	F4.3 §3.2
12	Office-holders: RBI Governor, Labour Minister, CEA	PIB	F4.2, F10.2

How to record the result. Do not annotate the PDF. Write the twelve answers on **one sheet**, dated, and keep it with your wall sheets. If a figure has not changed, write *"unchanged"* —

you need the positive confirmation, because "I did not find a change" and "I did not look" feel identical a week later.

4.1 The two-sentence rule for anything you cannot verify

If you cannot confirm a figure from a primary source, **do not carry it into the hall**. An unverified number is worse than no number, because of the marking scheme: F8.0 §6 records that a blind guess has an expected value of exactly zero, while an answer given confidently from a stale fact is a **negative** 0.8333 dressed up as knowledge.

Where a figure is uncertain, fall back on the structure. You may not remember whether the repo rate is 5.25% or 5.50%, but you will remember that **the MSF is 25 basis points above it and the SDF 25 below** — and questions about the corridor's *structure* are more common than questions about its level.

CHECK YOURSELF · SESSION 4

1. How long does the sweep take, and when is it done?
2. Name six of the twelve items
3. Why must you write "unchanged" rather than leave a blank?
4. What is the fallback when a figure cannot be verified?

5. Session 5 — The EPFO Watchlist ★★★★★

This is the section that makes Module 10 worth twelve hours rather than four. **The eight current affairs marks in an EPFO paper are not distributed like a general knowledge quiz** — they weight heavily towards this organisation, its statutes and its schemes.

5.1 The standing watchlist

Watch	Why it matters	Status at compilation
The four labour codes	Replace 29 central Acts; make pre-2025 labour material obsolete	In force from 21 Nov 2025; central rules notified 2026
EPF interest rate	Declared annually by the CBT , ratified by Government	8.25% for 2025-26
EPF wage ceiling	₹15,000 since 2014; a revision is under consideration	Still ₹15,000 — a proposal to raise it is not yet notified
Employees' Pension Scheme, 2026	Replaced EPS-95	In force from 29 June 2026
EPFO 3.0	UPI and ATM withdrawal, higher auto-settlement	Rolling out through 2026
ELI Scheme	EPFO-administered employment incentive	Effective from 1 Aug 2025
Gig and platform workers	Aggregator contributions under the Code on Social Security	Rules notified 2026
Higher EPS pension litigation	The 2022 Supreme Court option, and pending applications	Ongoing

F10.2 carries the detail and the sources for each.

IMPORTANT · A CURRENCY RISK IN THIS MANUAL'S OWN BACK CATALOGUE

Two of the items above are not merely new facts. **They invalidate content.**

1. **The four labour codes came into force on 21 November 2025, replacing 29 central labour laws** — including the Industrial Disputes Act 1947, the Payment of Wages Act 1936, the Minimum Wages Act 1948 and the Factories Act 1948
2. **The Employees' Pension Scheme, 2026 has replaced EPS-95** with effect from 29 June 2026

Modules 2 and 3 were completed before this manual's build pipeline existed and are not in src/ — see register §9. If they were written before late 2025, they teach the repealed Acts and EPS-95 **as live law**, which is a serious defect in the two modules that together carry about **52 planning marks**.

This cannot be checked from inside the repository, because the sources are not here. It is now the strongest reason to re-supply them: not merely so the master book can be built, but so that they can be **read against the codes and corrected**. Recorded in register §9 as the top of the queue.

5.2 How to read a change like the labour codes

When a statute is replaced, the examinable content is rarely the fine print. It is:

1. **What replaced what, and from when** — four codes, 29 Acts, 21 November 2025
2. **Which Acts were subsumed into which code** — wages into the Code on Wages; ID Act, Trade Unions Act and Standing Orders Act into the Industrial Relations Code; EPF, ESI, gratuity, maternity benefit into the Code on Social Security; Factories Act and Mines Act into the OSH Code
3. **The definitions that changed** — notably a **uniform definition of "wages"** across all four codes, and the new statutory categories of **gig worker** and **platform worker**
4. **The new numbers** — thresholds, time limits, contribution rates

That is four facts per code, not four hundred. Learn those and the codes are covered to the depth this paper requires.

CHECK YOURSELF · SESSION 5

1. Name the eight items on the standing watchlist
2. How many central Acts did the codes replace, and from what date?
3. Which code subsumed the EPF Act? Which subsumed the Industrial Disputes Act?
4. What are the four things to learn when a statute is replaced?
5. Why is the back catalogue now a currency risk and not merely an inconvenience?

6. Graded Practice — 20 Questions ★★★★★

These questions are deliberately built on the NON-decaying part of the module — institutional attribution and structural facts — so that the bank remains valid whenever you drill it. F10.2's bank carries the dated material.

Target: 20 to 30 seconds each.

6.1 Level 1 — Reports and publishers

- Q1.** The Human Development Report is published by (a) the World Bank (b) the International Monetary Fund (c) the United Nations Development Programme (d) the World Economic Forum
- Q2.** The World Development Report is published by (a) the World Bank (b) the United Nations Development Programme (c) the World Trade Organization (d) the OECD
- Q3.** The World Economic Outlook is published by (a) the World Economic Forum (b) the World Bank (c) UNCTAD (d) the International Monetary Fund
- Q4.** The Global Innovation Index is published by (a) the World Economic Forum (b) the World Intellectual Property Organization (c) UNESCO (d) the OECD
- Q5.** The Corruption Perceptions Index is published by (a) Transparency International (b) the UN Office on Drugs and Crime (c) the World Bank (d) Amnesty International
- Q6.** The Global Gender Gap Report is published by (a) UN Women (b) the United Nations Development Programme (c) the World Economic Forum (d) the International Labour Organization
- Q7.** The State of World Population report is published by (a) the World Health Organization (b) the United Nations Population Fund (c) UNICEF (d) the United Nations Development Programme
- Q8.** The SDG India Index is published by (a) the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (b) the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change (c) the Planning Commission (d) NITI Aayog

6.2 Level 2 — Institutions

- Q9.** The Annual Status of Education Report (ASER) is published by (a) the Pratham Education Foundation (b) the NCERT (c) the Ministry of Education (d) UNESCO
- Q10.** The World Employment and Social Outlook is published by (a) the World Bank (b) the International Labour Organization (c) the OECD (d) UNCTAD
- Q11.** The International Labour Organization was established in (a) 1945 (b) 1948 (c) 1919 (d) 1930
- Q12.** The International Labour Organization is distinctive among United Nations specialised agencies in having (a) universal membership (b) a rotating presidency (c) its headquarters in New York (d) a tripartite structure of governments, employers and workers
- Q13.** The Central Board of Trustees of the Employees' Provident Fund Organisation is chaired by (a) the Central Provident Fund Commissioner (b) the Union Minister for Labour and Employment (c) the Union

Finance Minister (d) the Cabinet Secretary

Q14. The e-Shram portal is a national database of (a) unorganised workers (b) income-tax assesseees (c) registered companies (d) provident fund pensioners

Q15. The International Labour Organization has its headquarters at (a) New York (b) Vienna (c) Geneva (d) Rome

Q16. Which one of the following statements is **not** correct? (a) The Economic Survey is tabled before the Union Budget is presented (b) The Periodic Labour Force Survey is conducted by the National Statistical Office (c) The Global Multidimensional Poverty Index is published jointly by UNDP and OPHI (d) The World Bank continues to publish the Ease of Doing Business rankings

6.3 Level 3 — Recruitment Test standard

Q17. The Global Hunger Index is published by (a) Concern Worldwide and Welthungerhilfe (b) the Food and Agriculture Organization (c) the World Food Programme (d) UNICEF

Q18. The World Happiness Report is released under the auspices of (a) the World Health Organization (b) the UN Sustainable Development Solutions Network (c) UNESCO (d) the OECD

Q19. The four labour codes were brought into force with effect from (a) 1 April 2021 (b) 1 October 2024 (c) 1 April 2026 (d) 21 November 2025

Q20. The number of central labour laws replaced by the four labour codes is (a) 14 (b) 22 (c) 29 (d) 44

7. Answers and Explanations

7.1 Level 1

Q	Ans	Explanation
1	c	UNDP , since 1990 — F4.4 §3.1
2	a	The World Bank . Note the pattern: <i>Development</i> belongs to the Bank, <i>Outlook</i> to the Fund — Q3 is the pair
3	d	The IMF . (b) the World Bank is the standard confusion, both being Bretton Woods institutions in Washington
4	b	WIPO . (a) the WEF publishes the <i>Global Competitiveness</i> and <i>Gender Gap</i> reports — a body with many indices, offered for one it does not publish
5	a	Transparency International , a non-governmental body — the assumption that an official-sounding index must be official is the trap
6	c	The World Economic Forum . Contrast the Gender Inequality Index , which is UNDP — two gender indices from two bodies, §2.2's second trap
7	b	UNFPA , the United Nations Population Fund
8	d	NITI Aayog , which also publishes the National MPI . (c) the Planning Commission ceased to exist in 2015 — F4.1 §4

7.2 Level 2

Q	Ans	Explanation
9	a	Pratham , a private foundation. §2.2's third trap: the most cited survey of Indian schooling outcomes is not a government publication
10	b	The ILO , which also publishes the <i>Global Wage Report</i>
11	c	1919 , under the Treaty of Versailles — making it the oldest of the UN specialised agencies, older than the UN itself, which it joined in 1946. (a) 1945 is the UN's own year, offered for exactly that reason
12	d	Tripartism — two government delegates, one employers' and one workers' delegate per member State, the last two voting independently of their government. §2.3
13	b	The Union Minister for Labour and Employment . (a) the Central PF Commissioner is the CBT's member-secretary and the organisation's chief executive, not its chairman — a closely related office, wrongly elevated
14	a	Unorganised workers
15	c	Geneva — as is the WTO. Washington DC has the IMF and the World Bank; Rome has the FAO and WFP; Vienna has the IAEA and UNODC
16	d	The "not correct" item . The World Bank discontinued the Ease of Doing Business rankings in 2021. (a), (b) and (c) are all correct. This is the stale-fact pattern: a report can be so well known that its discontinuation is not noticed

7.3 Level 3

Q	Ans	Explanation
17	a	Concern Worldwide and Welthungerhilfe — two European non-governmental organisations. (b) the FAO publishes the <i>State of Food Security</i> , which is the official counterpart and the natural wrong answer
18	b	The UN Sustainable Development Solutions Network
19	d	21 November 2025 . The Codes were enacted in 2019 and 2020 but were not brought into force for years, so the enactment years and the commencement date are different — and the commencement is what makes the older material wrong
20	c	29 central labour laws. §5.1 — and the reason this single fact carries so much weight is that it tells you the scale of what Modules 2 and 3 must be re-read against

THINK LIKE UPSC · THE THREE SHAPES IN THIS BANK

1. **The plausible institution.** Every wrong option in §6.1 is a real body that publishes real reports. None is absurd. **Learn the report-to-publisher table as pairs**, because recognition of the body is not enough — you must recognise the pairing
2. **Enactment against commencement.** Q19. A statute has a year of enactment and a date of coming into force, and for the labour codes they are **six years apart**. Where a question gives a date rather than a year, check which one is being asked
3. **The discontinued or superseded institution.** Q8's Planning Commission, Q16's Ease of Doing Business, and the Employees' Pension Scheme 1995 in F10.2. **A body or report that no longer exists is a reliable distractor**, because familiarity outlives existence

8. One-Minute Revision

ONE-MINUTE REVISION · CHAPTER F10.1

WEIGHT 20.0 marks, 12 hours, 8 questions · the only module that **cannot be finished** · spend it as **4 hours on attributions, 6 on recent definite changes, 2 on the pre-exam sweep**

THREE KINDS OF QUESTION 1 attribution (permanent, highest value) · **2 a recent definite change** (the sweet spot) · **3 a current reading** (decays fastest, least asked). **Do not spend the module chasing kind 3**

"INTEGRATED" MEANS a current item is worth learning only if it **attaches to the static syllabus** · attachment points in order: **labour and social security » economy » polity » science** · **sport, entertainment and trivia are not on the list**

PUBLISHERS HDR, IHDI, GII » UNDP · Global MPI » UNDP + OPHI · National MPI, SDG India Index » NITI AAYOG · World Development Report, Human Capital Index » WORLD BANK · World Economic Outlook, Fiscal Monitor » IMF · Global Competitiveness, GENDER GAP » WEF · Global Innovation Index » WIPO · Corruption Perceptions » TRANSPARENCY INTERNATIONAL · Global Hunger Index » CONCERN WORLDWIDE + WELTHUNGERHILFE · World Happiness » UN SDSN · Press Freedom » RSF · State of World Population » UNFPA · State of Food Security » FAO · World Employment and Social Outlook, Global Wage Report » ILO · ASER » PRATHAM (private) · NFHS » Health Ministry via IIPS · SRS » Registrar General

THE THREE TRAPS *Development and Human Capital* = **Bank**; *Outlook and Fiscal Monitor* = **Fund** · **Gender GAP = WEF, Gender INEQUALITY = UNDP** · **ASER and the Hunger Index are PRIVATE bodies** · the World Bank **DISCONTINUED Ease of Doing Business in 2021**

ILO 1919, Treaty of Versailles, **oldest UN specialised agency**, UN agency from 1946 · **HQ GENEVA · TRIPARTITE — 2 government + 1 employer + 1 worker per State**, the last two voting **independently** · India a founder member

EPFO apex body the **Central Board of Trustees, chaired by the Union Minister for Labour and Employment**; the **Central PF Commissioner is the chief executive, not the chairman** · also tripartite

HEADQUARTERS Geneva » **ILO, WTO** · Washington DC » **IMF, World Bank** · Rome » **FAO, WFP** · Vienna » **IAEA, UNODC**

SOURCES IN ORDER 1 PIB · 2 one newspaper, daily · 3 Ministry of Labour and EPFO circulars · 4 PRS Legislative Research · 5 RBI and MoSPI releases

THE DAILY HABIT 15 minutes — 10 reading, 5 recording · **one sheet a month, four columns: date, item, WHICH MODULE IT ATTACHES TO, why it might be asked** · an item

that attaches to nothing is discarded

MONTHLY strike out what did not become durable · **move surviving items into the module's own notes** · write five questions · **by the end there should be no current affairs file, only updated Modules 1 to 9**

THE SWEEP in the **fortnight before** the paper, about **two hours, twelve items**: repo rate · inflation · GDP growth · fiscal deficit · **EPF interest rate** · **EPF wage ceiling** · new EPFO circulars · labour code rules · unemployment and LFPR · Census 2027 · GST rates · office-holders. **Write "unchanged" rather than leaving a blank**

IF YOU CANNOT VERIFY IT, DO NOT CARRY IT. A stale fact answered confidently is **-0.8333**, while a blank is **0** · **fall back on STRUCTURE: MSF is 25 bps above repo, SDF 25 below**

WHEN A STATUTE IS REPLACED, LEARN FOUR THINGS what replaced what and **from when** · which Acts went into which code · the **definitions that changed** · the new numbers

THE CODES four codes replaced 29 central Acts, in force **21 NOVEMBER 2025** · enacted 2019–2020 — **enactment year and commencement date are different**

9. Five-Minute Wall Sheet

FIVE-MINUTE WALL SHEET · CHAPTER F10.1

ATTRIBUTION IS PERMANENT AND CHEAP. LEARN THE TABLE, NOT THE NEWS

DEVELOPMENT = BANK · OUTLOOK = FUND

GENDER GAP = WEF · GENDER INEQUALITY = UNDP

INNOVATION = WIPO · CORRUPTION = TRANSPARENCY INTERNATIONAL

HUNGER = CONCERN + WELTHUNGERHILFE · HAPPINESS = UN SDSN

ASER = PRATHAM, NOT GOVERNMENT

EASE OF DOING BUSINESS WAS DISCONTINUED IN 2021

NATIONAL MPI + SDG INDEX = NITI AAYOG · GLOBAL MPI = UNDP + OPHI

ILO 1919 · GENEVA · TRIPARTITE · OLDEST UN AGENCY

CBT IS CHAIRED BY THE LABOUR MINISTER, NOT THE PF COMMISSIONER

GENEVA: ILO, WTO · WASHINGTON: IMF, WORLD BANK

PIB FIRST. ONE PAPER, DAILY. EPFO CIRCULARS. PRS

ONE SHEET A MONTH. THIRD COLUMN = WHICH MODULE. NO ATTACHMENT, NO ENTRY

END OF MONTH: MOVE ITEMS INTO THE MODULE'S OWN NOTES

FORTNIGHT BEFORE: THE TWELVE-ITEM SWEEP. WRITE "UNCHANGED"

UNVERIFIED FACT = -0.8333. BLANK = 0. STRUCTURE BEATS LEVEL

LABOUR CODES: 4 CODES, 29 ACTS, 21 NOVEMBER 2025

ENACTED 2019–20, IN FORCE 2025. THE TWO DATES ARE DIFFERENT

ONE LINE FOR THE INTERVIEW Current affairs for this examination is not general knowledge but the updating of the static syllabus — the labour codes replacing twenty-nine Acts and the new pension scheme superseding EPS-95 are not news items, they are corrections to what the law is, and a candidate who memorised the repealed Acts has learnt the wrong subject rather than merely an old one.

ACTION · NEXT

F10.2 — Schemes, Institutions and the Current Dossier. It carries the dated content: the labour codes in detail, the EPFO items, and the economy and demography figures, each with a source and each on §4's sweep list.